

PARTICIPANT INFORMATION SHEET & CONSENT FORM (INTERVIEW)

Project Title:

LogiConnect: A Website for Logistics Company Discovery and Customer Engagement

Researcher:

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Supervisor:

Dr. Ama Kulathilake

School of Computing and Engineering

University of West London

1. Purpose of the Study

The purpose of this interview is to gather opinions and insights from potential users regarding the need for a digital platform that supports logistics company discovery and customer engagement. The findings will help evaluate user expectations, common challenges, and the potential usefulness of the proposed LogiConnect platform.

2. What Participation Involves

If you agree to take part, you will be asked to participate in a short interview lasting approximately **5–10 minutes**.

During the interview, you may be asked questions related to:

- Your experience with logistics or shipping services
- Difficulties in finding suitable logistics providers
- Expectations from a digital logistics platform
- Opinions on features such as search, inquiry handling, tracking, and feedback

The interview may be conducted:

- In person

- Over the phone
- Or through an online communication platform

No technical knowledge is required.

3. Voluntary Participation

Your participation in this interview is completely voluntary.

You are free to:

- Decline participation
- Skip any question you do not wish to answer
- Withdraw from the interview at any time before completion

No explanation is required, and there will be no negative consequences.

4. Risks and Discomfort

This study involves **minimal risk**.

No physical, psychological, or emotional harm is expected.

The interview questions are general and relate only to user experiences and opinions about logistics-related services and digital platforms.

5. Confidentiality and Data Protection

Your privacy will be respected throughout the research process.

- No sensitive personal information will be collected
- Your responses will be used **only for academic purposes**
- Any notes or recordings (if used) will be stored securely
- Your identity will **not** be revealed in the final report
- Findings may be included in the project report, but participants will remain anonymous

If direct quotations are used, they will be presented anonymously.

6. Audio Recording (Optional – Include only if you may record)

With your permission, the interview may be **audio recorded** for note-taking and accuracy purposes only.

- The recording will be used only for academic research
- It will not be shared publicly
- It will be deleted after the research is completed

If you do **not** wish to be recorded, written notes may be taken instead.

7. Benefits of Participation

Although there is no direct personal benefit, your participation will contribute to the development and evaluation of a digital platform aimed at improving logistics service discovery and customer interaction.

Your views may help improve the usability and practical relevance of the proposed system.

8. Contact Information

If you have any questions about this study, please contact:

Siththirakumar Dakshan

Email: 34150808@student.uwl.ac.uk

If you have concerns regarding the ethical conduct of this research, you may contact the **University of West London School Ethics Panel**.

9. Consent Statement

Please tick the boxes below:

- ☒ I confirm that I have read and understood the information provided above.
- ☒ I understand that my participation is voluntary.
- ☒ I understand that I may withdraw at any time before the interview is completed.
- ☒ I agree to take part in this interview study.

☒ I agree / ~~do not agree~~ to the interview being audio recorded

Participant Name: Mr. Anil Pathirana

Signature: Anil

Date: 28.01.2026

Researcher Signature: S. Dakshan

Date: Dr.

☒ I agree / ~~do not agree~~ to the interview being audio recorded

Participant Name: Ms. G. Dhorjee

Signature: *[Signature]*

Date: 02.02.2026

Researcher Signature: S. Dakshan

Date: *[Signature]*